

Student Steals:

AI-Powered Student Deal Discovery & Budget Coach

The Problem:

College students frequently overspend because they don't know about affordable options around them. Discounts and deals are scattered across different apps, emails, and promotions, making it difficult to quickly find the best value nearby. At the same time, most budgeting tools show spending data but don't help users make smarter real-time decisions about where to spend their money.

Our Solution:

StudenSteals is an AI-powered platform that helps students discover nearby deals and make smarter financial decisions in real time. By combining location data, real business listings, and AI insights, the app highlights affordable options near the user and provides personalized budgeting advice. Students can instantly see nearby "steals," track their spending, and receive AI-powered recommendations on how to save money.

Key Features:

Nearby "Steals" Finder:

Uses the Google Places API to discover real businesses near the user and generates money-saving tips for each location using Gemini AI.

Interactive Deal Map:

An interactive map powered by Leaflet.js shows nearby deals with clickable markers so students can visually explore savings around campus.

AI Financial Coach:

A chatbot powered by Google Gemini provides personalized advice and recommendations based on the user's location and spending habits.

Budget Tracker:

Students can set monthly spending limits for categories like food, transportation, and entertainment. The system tracks transactions and highlights overspending.

AI Spending Insights:

Gemini analyzes budget vs. spending data to generate personalized reports and actionable savings recommendations.

How It Works

1. The app detects the user's GPS location
2. The backend queries Google Places to find nearby businesses
3. The system sends those businesses to Gemini AI in a single batched prompt
4. Gemini generates student-friendly saving tips for each location.
5. Only one API call is needed to find 10 restaurants in your area.

StudenSteals helps students discover affordable options near campus, make smarter spending decisions, stay within budget, and reduce financial stress. By combining real-world location data with AI-driven financial insights, StudentSteals transforms how students approach everyday spending.